The Way Ahead

As the global economic order shifts towards Asia, Indian B-schools are well-positioned to become hubs for global business education. But they first have to implement significant reforms in curriculum design, upgrade infrastructure, and diversify intake diversification. With the right strategies, Indian institutions could soon populate global rankings, a trend that is already visible with 14 Indian B-schools appearing in the *Financial Times* business school ranking this time, up from 11 in 2023.

The future of management education in India is of adaptation and innovation. As technological advancements continue to disrupt traditional industries, B-schools must ensure their graduates are equipped not just with theoretical knowledge but with practical, application-ready skills. The India Today Group MDRA Best Business School Survey 2024 emphasises the need for continuous qualitative improvement rather than mere numerical expansion. The gap between the top and bottom schools can only be bridged by fostering competition based on quality, innovation and relevance.

14

B-SCHOOLS
from India appeared in the *Financial Times* business school rankings this year

Learning also has to be a lifelong process, a trend that the integration of EdTech is helping. Platforms such as upGrad continue to lead in offering online management courses, providing access to quality education to students and helping professionals continuously upskill to stay relevant in the constantly changing job market.

Indians are already at the head of such global behemoths as Google and Microsoft, the World Bank and IMF. But to continue to shape the global business leaders of tomorrow, Indian B-schools must make a concerted and sustained effort to embrace technological change, foster inclusivity and align academic offerings with industry demands. With India poised to become one of the largest economies in the world, the role of management education in driving this growth cannot be overstated. ■

METHODOLOGY

HOW THE B-SCHOOLS WERE RANKED

The 2024 India Today Group survey of the country's business schools was conducted by reputed Delhi-based market research firm Marketing & Development Research Associates (MDRA). Based on the most recent data, this is the most credible and exhaustive rankings of India's Best B-schools. It provides a comprehensive analysis of key areas, clearly highlighting which courses are best suited for different categories of aspirants. Three types of business programmes were ranked, each designed to cater to the unique needs and ambitions of various aspirant profiles.

FULL-TIME MBA/ PGDM RANKING

A comprehensive list of B-schools, offering full-time classroom management programmes (PGDM/ MBA), established at least five years ago and with a minimum of three batches that have passed out till the academic year ending in 2023, was considered for the rankings. An objective questionnaire was finetuned to obtain the latest relevant information—current year data—from the institutes on 127 attributes to give stakeholders more realistic, updated and accurate information. More than 2,500 B-schools across India, fulfilling the qualification criteria for participation, were contacted and 275 of them responded within the deadline.

After receiving the objective data, four processes—data cleaning, logical checks, validation, back-checks and audits—were conducted. In the first stage, every aspect of the details provided by the B-schools was care-